IX - Zamboanga Peninsula	4	2	4
X - Northern Mindanao	2	2	2
XI - Davao Region	1	3	5
XII - SOCCSKSARGEN	2	2	1
XIII - Caraga	1	3	3
ARMM	1	2	2
Party-List	10	15	20
TOTAL (w/ Party-List)	55	66	88
TOTAL (w/o Party-List)	45	51	68

Source: HOR 2022. Computations made by the authors.

Overall, the abovementioned situation indicates that Filipino women have gradually increased their presence in formal politics. In Asia, the Philippines and Taiwan are the only countries above the global average of 24.5 percent of women in parliament (Liu 2021). However, challenges remain as the increased participation of women comes from dysfunctional features of the country's political system: political dynasties and the Party-List law. Nonetheless, not all women from these groups are necessarily averse to women's issues.

Barriers to Filipino Women's Participation

Previous studies have identified political, economic, and cultural factors that impede women's participation in politics. However, context still matters since the perception of women's role in societies and the evolution of political systems differ. The following section examines some of these barriers.

The Philippine electoral system's "first-past-the-post" electoral type, coupled with the lack of well-developed political parties, inhibits women's entry into politics. Encinas-Franco (2021) argues that "[w]ithout party discipline and institutionalized rules within parties, one